Kabiru Abubakari

Ph.D. Candidate in Statistics

School of Mathematical Sciences, Queen Mary University of London

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Education

Ph.D. in Statistics 2023 – 2026 (expected)

Queen Mary University of London, UK

Primary supervisor: Prof. Silvia Liverani. Secondary supervisors: Prof. Andrew R. Leitch and Dr. Ilia J. Leitch.

MSc Data Analysis (M1 DASEE) 2021 – 2023

University of Burgundy, Dijon, France

B.A. Economics 2016 – 2020

University for Development Studies, Tamale, Ghana

Employment

Postdoctoral Research Assistant (Part-time) Mar – Jul 2026

School of Mathematical Sciences, QMUL

Worked on Dynamic Bayesian Causal Models.

Consultant, Statistics and Data Science Clinic 2025

School of Mathematical Sciences, QMUL

Graduate Teaching Assistant 2024 – 2026

School of Mathematical Sciences, QMUL

LMS Levelling-up Mathematics Tutor 2024 – 2025

London Mathematical Society (LMS)

Taught A-level mathematics to encourage students to pursue STEM in higher education.

Graduate Teaching Assistant 2023 – 2024

King's College London (KCL)

Research Assistant, ECONRES Research Group Apr – Jun 2022

Autonomous University of Madrid (UAM), Madrid, Spain

Worked on latent factor models and spatial econometrics.

Teaching and Administrative Assistant 2020 – 2021

University for Development Studies, Tamale, Ghana

Completed one-year national service.

Publications & Manuscripts

[1] **Abubakari, K.**, Matechou, E., Henniges, M.C., Leitch, I.J., Leitch, A.R., & Liverani, S. (2026). False positives, false negatives, and the detection-only problem: A hierarchical model for species occurrence with observation error. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2606.26323*. https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2606.26323

[2] **Abubakari, K.**, & Liverani, S. (2026). Data generation for the logistic regression model under controlled conditions. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2610.12381*. https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2610.12381

[3] Henniges, M.C., **Abubakari, K.**, Liverani, S., Antonelli, A., Leitch, I.J., & Leitch, A.R. (2026). Plant genome sizes, functional traits and Ellenberg values indicate that nitrogen deposition is a driver of changing species area trends across Britain over 30 years. *Submitted to the Journal of Ecology.*

[4] Dary, S.K., Yendaw, E., **Abubakari, K.** et al. (2025). Determinants of gender preferences for candidates standing in representative democratic elections in Ghana. *Journal of Economics, Race, and Policy*. https://doi.org/10.1007/s41996-025-00169-3

[5] Issahaku, H., **Abubakari, K.**, & Basit, D.A. (2023). Patterns and causal connections between changes in exchange rates and interest rates in Ghana. *Ghana Journal of Development Studies*, 20(1), 1–19. https://doi.org/10.4314/gjds.v20i1.1

Grants & Awards

Queen Mary Principal's Award 2023 – 2026
Queen Mary University of London
Full tuition fees plus monthly stipend for 3.5 years.

£1,500 Doctoral College Postgraduate Research Award 2026
Queen Mary University of London
Grant to support research travel, including conferences.

$500 Junior Research Award 2026
International Society for Bayesian Analysis (ISBA)
Awarded to early-career researchers presenting at the 2026 ISBA World Meeting.

€8,000 ISITE-BFC International Master's Scholarship 2022 – 2023
University of Burgundy
Awarded for the MSc DASEE.

€610 Dynastage Student Grant 2022
Regional Council of Bourgogne-Franche-Comté
Awarded to support student mobility within the MSc DASEE programme (Grant No. 2022-DE-02378).

€956 Erasmus+ Internship Mobility Scholarship 2022
University of Burgundy
Awarded for a research internship in Spain, second semester 2021–2022, within the MSc DASEE.

€8,000 ISITE-BFC International Master's Scholarship 2021 – 2022
University of Burgundy
Awarded for the MSc DASEE.

Conferences

ISBA World Meeting 2026
Nagoya, Japan · Poster presentation

Joint Statistical Meetings 2025
Nashville, Tennessee, USA · Poster presentation

Spatial Statistics: At the Dawn of AI 2025
Noordwijk, Netherlands · Poster presentation

Environmental and Ecological Statistics Conference 2025
Lancaster, England, UK · Talk

Royal Statistical Society Annual Conference 2024
Brighton, England, UK · Poster presentation

Research Students Conference 2023
Sheffield, England, UK · Talk

Teaching

Teaching assistant for the following modules at QMUL:

- **Probability and Statistics** – first-year undergraduates
- **Statistical Modelling I** (classical/frequentist statistics) – first-year undergraduates
- **Statistical Modelling II** (classical/frequentist statistics) – third-year undergraduates
- **Bayesian Statistical Methods** – third-year undergraduates
- **Time Series Analysis** – third-year undergraduates
- **Computational Statistics** – MSc students
- **Biostatistics** (QMUL–Nanchang Joint Workshop) – joint Biomedical Sciences / Clinical Biomedicine degree offered by QMUL and Nanchang University, China

Public Engagement & Outreach

Historical contributions of different cultures to mathematics 2024
Abubakari, K., Al-Mahdawy, Z., Alsulami, H., Garetto, C., Lucero-Azuara, N., Marajh, J., … & Sansom, R.
Available online.

QMUL Festival of Communities 2023
Queen Mary University of London, London, UK
Participated in the annual community engagement festival, promoting mathematics to the wider public.

Skills

Software	R, Python, Stata, SQL
Version control	GitHub
Languages	English (fluent), French (beginner)

Referees

Professor Silvia Liverani
Queen Mary University of London, UK
s.liverani@qmul.ac.uk

Professor Andrew R. Leitch
Queen Mary University of London, UK
a.r.leitch@qmul.ac.uk

Dr. Ilia J. Leitch
Royal Botanic Gardens, Kew, UK
i.leitch@kew.org

Professor Coro Chasco
Autonomous University of Madrid, Spain
coro.chasco@uam.es